

Interview Prep with Communications & Career Services

Orientation 2018

What is an interview?

- An awkward, unnatural event?
- An opportunity to meet someone new and learn?
- A “show and tell”?
- A conversation between/among equals?
- A performance?
- A monologue?
- All of the above?



The job interview begins before the job interview

- Choose the right wardrobe
- Get familiar with the route/transportation options
- Prepare a script
- Mock interview with someone
- Anticipate the questions
- Have good questions to ask
- Get a good night's sleep



Do Your Homework

Review their website:

- Company structure, clients, products, mission, current research
 - What sets them apart from competition?

Get to know the players:

- LinkedIn- view your interviewer and other teammates
 - Are there alumni that work there you can reach out to? 2nd years?

Check what other people are saying:

- Glassdoor- Interview Questions/Style
- LinkedIn- past employees could give you insights

Interviews for MSCF students

- Coding Challenges (technical)
- HireVue Video Interviews (behavioral)
- Skype
- On-site
- Super days

Video Interviews

- Dress the part
- Check your lighting/level of camera
- Remove any distractions behind you
- Turn off cellphone
- Look at the camera when you speak
- Remember to smile
- Always test it out before the interview
- Login to Skype early to be ready to go

At the job interview

- Give a smile and firm handshake
- Make eye contact
- Remember names (repeat them)
- Show warmth and competence (more later)
- Pay attention to their body language
- Listen (Nod, Affirm, Question, Restate, Smile)
- Vary Vocal Quality (Pitch, Speed, Modulation)
- Speak slowly and confidently; there's no hurry



First Impressions Count

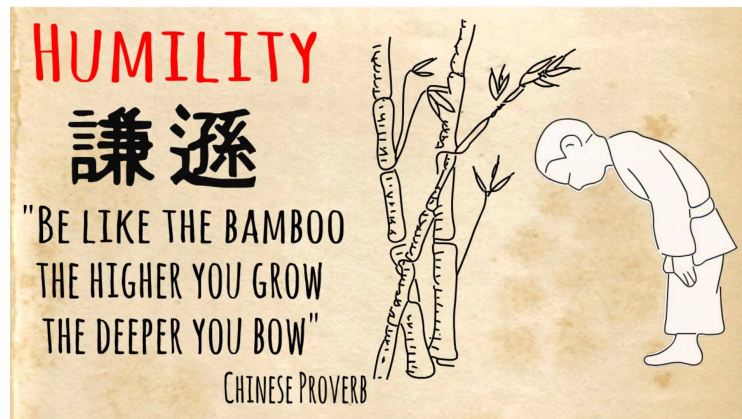
- You don't get a second chance to make a great first impression
- Remember Brain Functioning
 - Do I trust you?
 - Can you fit the team/culture?
 - Can you add value?
- Beware of Body Language
 - Are you warm and friendly?
 - Are you confident?



Talk about yourself (competence), but not with arrogance.

“I’ve worked hard to understand what clients want, and I’m proud of the successes I’ve had with them.”

“Others have helped me develop those strengths.”



Ask the right questions (have a conversation).

- “How did you come to be in your role at the company?”
- “What are you currently working on?”

(The answers might reveal similarities in your background, experience, or goals, or give you the opportunity to express empathy and understanding regarding shared challenges.)

- Ask the right questions. Get the right job.



Be prepared for

Behavioral Interviews

A Job Interviewing technique whereby the applicant is asked to describe the past behavior in order to determine whether she is suitable for a position



Own a word. Show a benefit. Tell a story.

- **Word:** I am “innovative.”
- **Benefit:** I can bring new approaches to your company.
- **Story:** One evening I was waiting for an important phone call on my cell phone (I had no land line). I noticed my battery was low on power. When I tried to charge it, my charger was broken. I found some spare parts and created a hybrid charger. It worked and I got my call.



Think STAR.



DON'T FORGET TO ADD THE TAKEAWAY—WHAT DID YOU LEARN?

What is Your Weakness?

- Have a weakness (that is not also a strength) . It shows your self-awareness and willingness to adapt.
- Choose a skill-based weakness or something that you can easily show how you're improving
 - Communication—joined Toastmasters
- Share how you are working to improve!



END STRONG.

- Have questions prepared to ask interviewer
- Summarize why you are a good fit.
- Ask about next steps.
- Thank the interviewer(s).
- Give a firm handshake.



Follow Up.

- Send a **brief** thank you email.
- Write a **handwritten** thank you note to differentiate yourself.
- Provide something of **value** (a link to an article you read).

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谢谢

OK, let's practice.



Interview Activity (1 hour)

- Presenters handout rubrics
 - Break into groups of 4
 - Each person will take a turn being interviewed for ~15 minutes
 - 1 interviewer
 - 1 interviewee
 - 2 (or more) observers
1. Interviewer asks interviewee questions on rubric; observers and interviewer takes notes
 2. Group then gives feedback to interviewee
 3. Next person volunteers to be interviewed

Group Activity Debrief

- What were the most common themes of behavior or feedback given?
- What did you learn?
- What areas do you need more practice?
- Any interview resources that have helped you that you can share?

Questions?

- Reminders: Recruiting Prep Session on Thursday

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